

the frequency of automatic Windows update, blocking certain programs from being accessed (browsers or monitoring applications), configuring Windows installer to prevent installation of certain software (such as games) and enforcing a certain amount of complexity in passwords are a handful of them. ADS can be used to separate and organize computers by departments using domains. Trust policies can be used to avail certain services in a second domain to computers of first domain.

ADS is at the heart of enterprise level management for PCs and not all Windows editions can join a domain. In case of Windows 8, only the Pro and Enterprise editions can. That being said, a Windows 8 PC (general edition) can be installed on an office PC but can't be controlled using ADS. In other words, Active Directory Services can run on Windows Server Editions and client computers can only join a domain. You cannot create a domain on a Windows 8 PC.

Policies are the rules that can be used to limit and restrict functionality of the Windows PC depending on your needs. These can be enforced via the ADS using the Group Policy editor available in Windows 8 Pro and Enterprise versions. While it is an enterprise feature, it can also be used

by home users to restrict other users from tinkering around with their PCs. Everything from disabling 'New hardware found' balloons to disallowing the 'Format' option for USB drives – here's where it happens. Group Policy editor is not child's play however. Don't play around with this if you don't know what you're doing lest you regret it later.



You need to enforce the rules in AppLocker to bring them to effect

AppLocker

This feature saw the light of day in Windows 7 and is there in Windows 8 Enterprise (only). If the name doesn't make it obvious, may we tell you that AppLocker is a dream feature for bosses who're always striving to improve employee productivity. It simply disallows applications from running. This feature answers four questions:

1. Which applications should a user have access to run? – Be it playing Mahjongg or starting Windows Media Player, AppLocker can help.